Appendix One: Information Leaflet

NHS
Greater Glasgow and Clyde

Information about

Home Phototherapy

What is jaundice?

Jaundice is the name given to yellowing of the skin and whites of the eyes because of high levels of bilirubin in the blood**.** It is very common in newborn babies and usually clears by 10 to 14 days of life in most babies. Staff will have given you the Jaundice Information Leaflet which explains what jaundice is in more detail. Please refer to this but feel free to ask our staff any questions.

How do we treat jaundice?

Your baby may need **Phototherapy** (light treatment) to treat their jaundice. We use a special blue light to help break down bilirubin and remove jaundice from the body.

What is home phototherapy?

If your baby needs phototherapy, we will consider if we are able to provide this care in your home. Before we do that, we need to be confident that your baby is feeding well, and they are able to maintain their own temperature. The Medical team and Hospital at Home Team will assess your baby and decide if home phototherapy is appropriate for you and your baby.

Home phototherapy involves a medical device called Bilicocoon, which includes a swaddle blanket and an ultraviolet light which helps to remove jaundice from the body.



For the treatment to be effective, your baby will need phototherapy for most of the day (24 hours). You can take short breaks for up to 30 minutes for feeding, for changing and cuddling your baby. We will give your baby eye shields to help protect your baby's eyes from the phototherapy light.

How do we monitor jaundice?

Your baby will need bloods tests every day to measure the bilirubin level, also known as the SBR or "bili". Staff will need to take a very small sample of blood from your baby's heel. If we are unable to do this in your home, we may ask you to return to the neonatal unit for this test.

If the bilirubin level is rising, we may need to admit your baby to hospital for more tests. The bilirubin needs to be below a certain level before we can stop the phototherapy. The team will keep you updated and tell you when to stop the phototherapy. Once the phototherapy has been stopped, we will need to take a further blood sample to make sure the level is not rising again, this is called "the rebound."

How to use the BiliCocoon

The nursing team will show you how to set up the equipment

1. Position the BiliCocoon on top of your baby's mattress in their cot or crib.

2. Position the light box away from your baby, on a flat, stable surface. This surface should be free from clutter and away from water.
3. Insert the cable into the machine. Use one hand to insert the cable and one to keep the light box secure and stable.
4. Plug the light box into a suitable power supply and make sure that you can't trip over the wires.
5. Apply the disposable cover to BiliCocoon
6. Place the eye shields onto baby's eyes before starting phototherapy
7. Place your baby on top of the BiliCocoon wearing only a nappy.
8. Wrap your baby in the BiliCocoon as shown by the nursing staff
9. Switch on the power

Important things to note

- For hygienic reasons, never place a baby onto the BiliCocoon without the disposable cover
- Do not allow the fibre optic cable to be crushed as this may damage the protective cover and the optical fibres
- If the fibre optic cable or mattress is ripped, punctured or damaged in any way, stop using the equipment and contact the Neonatal Unit as soon as possible
- The light box is not waterproof. Keep it away from liquids as spillage may damage the equipment and can create an electric shock hazard.
- Do not look directly at the blue light if you experience light sensitivity. Doing so may cause headaches, nausea or mild vertigo. Turn off the light whilst attending to your baby.
- Do not clean the light box or mattress with abrasive cleaners, alcohol, acetone, or other solvents. Nursing staff will provide you with detergent wipes which you should use for cleaning.
- Always switch off the power and disconnect from the light box before cleaning the equipment

General Information

How to check your baby's temperature

The best way to check your baby's temperature is by putting your hand on the back of your baby's neck or their chest. Their hands and feet will always be cooler than the rest of their body so don't use this as a guide.

How do I know if my baby is getting sufficient milk?

Your baby will be waking for feeds and will be having at least **6** feeds in **24** hours.

Your baby is generally calm, relaxed and content after most feeds.

Your baby's nappies can help you to understand if your baby's feeding is going well. Speak with your midwife if you have any concerns.

Baby's age	Wet nappies – what to look for	Dirty nappies - what to look for
1-2 days old	1-2 or more a day Urates may be present – this is a dark pink or red substance that many babies pass in the first couple of days. At this age they are not a problem, however if they go beyond the first couple of days, you should speak to a health professional as this may be a sign that your baby is not getting enough milk.	1 or more dark green or black 'tar like' called meconium
3-4 days old	3 or more wet nappies per day Nappies feel heavier	At least 2 dirty nappies, changing in colour, changing in colour and consistency - brown, green or yellow, becoming looser ('changing stool')
5-6 days old	5 or more wet nappies per day Heavy wet	At least 2 dirty nappies, yellow – may be quite watery

7-28 days old	6 or more we nappies per day Heavy wet	At least 2 nappies, at least the size of a £2 coin yellow and watery, 'seedy' appearance

How do I know if my baby is more jaundice?

Your baby's skin turns brighter yellow or orange. Your baby is very sleepy, including difficult to wake for feeds.

What are the side effects of phototherapy?

Your baby may have loose stools (poo) or stools that are greenish in colour. This is normal and is the body's way of removing the bilirubin.

How should my baby sleep on the BiliCocoon?

Put your baby on their **back** for every sleep and in a clear flat sleep space.

Contact details

You can contact the Hospital at Home team between 8am and 8pm on

07866 957 495

Out with these hours you can contact:

Royal Hospital for Children: 0141 452 4929

Review Date: May 2027